

THOMAS KNIGHT, MChem, AMRSC

Research Scientist, Data Analyst and Science Communicator

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SUMMARY

A highly motivated Research Scientist and Science Communicator with 5+ years of experience in pharmaceutical R&D, including professional work developing **GLP-1 diabetes treatments at Pfizer**. As an individual living with **Type 1 Diabetes (T1D)**, I am deeply committed to Breakthrough T1D's mission to drive life-changing research. I combine technical expertise (1st Class MChem) with a **Google Professional Project Management Certificate** and experience coordinating milestones for a **\$65 million international drug discovery research grant**. Passionate about communicating complex scientific research towards public audiences, evidenced through posting regular open-science research updates, a peer reviewed scientific publication, 35+ hours of STEM Ambassadorship volunteering, and a successful science communication YouTube channel.

KEY SKILLS

- **Science Communication and Public Engagement:** Expert at presenting complex data to diverse and public audiences (students to global stakeholders) via open-science social media management (YouTube, X, GitHub).
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Experience managing high-value accounts and international research collaborations (US-UK READDI-AVIDD grant).
- **Project Management:** Google Certified Professional; experienced in overseeing project milestones, budgets, and technical teams.
- **Data Analysis & Impact Reporting:** Proficient in Python and Power BI to track engagement metrics and research outcomes.
- **Empathy & Relationship Building:** Strong interpersonal skills developed through patient-adjacent dental accounts, community volunteering and retail roles. Type 1 Diabetic with a personal interest in helping Breakthrough T1D succeed in its cause.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Account Manager

 **03/2024 - Present**  **Knights Dental Design Ltd, London**

- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Managed top 20 high-value accounts, reducing client churn through proactive engagement and issue resolution (e.g. resolving recurring scan issues with clinicians which decreased the remake rate from 6% to 2%).
- **Administrative Oversight & Compliance:** Overhauled the Quality Management System (QMS) to secure 100% DAMAS compliance, demonstrating the meticulous attention to detail required for managing research award documentation.
- **Process Improvement:** Implemented digital traceability systems, reducing administrative prep time by 30%.
- **Portfolio & Financial Management:** Oversaw business financial accounts and reported weekly cash flows to Directors, identifying cost-saving opportunities and ensuring budget accuracy.

Research Scientist (PhD) / Project Lead

 **09/2021 - 03/2024**  **University College London (UCL), London**

- Medicinal chemist synthesising, purifying and analysing potential AI-designed antiviral drug molecules against Coronaviruses funded by an EPSRC grant.
- **Grant Coordination:** Served as a key researcher for a **\$65 million US-UK international grant (READDI-AVIDD)**, coordinating drug discovery tasks and milestones between international partners. **Contributed to a successful £520k grant** for a new biophysics system (Creoptix WAVEsystem) for drug discovery projects.
- **Committee & Stakeholder Support:** Prepared and presented weekly project updates to international US-UK stakeholders; provided administrative support for meetings, including **drafting technical briefing documents, coordinating logistics, and recording official minutes** to track project milestones.
- **Public Engagement & Open Science:** Championed Open Science initiatives and drove public engagement by regularly disseminating research updates via social media (Twitter, GitHub, LinkedIn), translating complex AI-driven drug discovery concepts into accessible content for non-specialist audiences, with a **proven ability to manage web-based content and digital engagement** to promote research opportunities.
- **Operational Efficiency:** Designed 15 Python-automated data flows for molecule design and analysis, reducing sample analysis time by 98%, showcasing the ability to leverage IT packages to streamline research operations. Used machine learning to plan experiments, reduce campaign timelines from weeks to days, and cut material costs by 93%.

Organic Chemistry Undergraduate

 **09/2019 - 09/2020** 📍 **Pfizer UK, Chemical Research and Development Division, Sandwich**

- **Diabetes Research Expertise:** Conducted 12 months of R&D in a cGMP environment focused on the organic synthesis of pharmaceutical treatments for diabetes (GLP-1).
- **Science technical skills** Delivered high-purity drug material ahead of Phase II clinical deadlines, coordinating with interdisciplinary teams and international suppliers to resolve technical production challenges.
- **Data reporting and visualisation:** Migrated compliance reporting workflows to Power BI, improving the speed of operational decision-making for senior management by 40%. Performed internal audit reports, using MS Office (Excel, PowerPoint) to collate data and visualise results.
- **Public Engagement:** Volunteered as a Pfizer Community Lab Mentor, guiding A-level students through practical science. Represented Pfizer as a Society of Chemical Industry (SCI) Ambassador at the Royal Society of Chemistry.
- **Process improvement:** Lead a sustainability-focused project, implementing new catalyst and flow technologies that reduced chemical waste by 33% and improved overall process safety. Executed production scale-up and successfully delivered 5kg of >95%-purity diabetes drug material ahead of Phase II patient clinical deadlines.

Retail Store Manager

 **04/2016 – 10/2016** 📍 **Stanhill Farm, Wilmington, United Kingdom**

- Reduced weekly 'shrinkage' (stock loss) by 15% by executing a strategic markdown and reduction schedule for fresh produce, ensuring products nearing their sell-by date were prominently merchandised to maximise sales.
- Improved delivery 'cage-to-shelf' turnaround time by 20% by reorganising the back-of-house storage area, allowing for faster stock movement and ensuring the shop floor was 'grand-opening ready' for customers by 8:00 AM.

INVOLVEMENT AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Founder – 'Practical Cheminformatics' YouTube Channel

 **09/2025 - Present** 📍 **London/Southeast England**

- Created video tutorials on Python automation and AI to improve laboratory research productivity, particularly in drug discovery. Manage digital content creation and community engagement with a global audience of learners.

Level 1 Coach, Badminton England

 **05/2024 - Present** 📍 **London/Southeast England**

- Level 1 Accredited Coach, developing leadership and motivational skills through one-to-one badminton coaching lessons, creating tailored development plans for clients (e.g. managing blood sugars in tournaments for diabetic players).

STEM Ambassador

📅 09/2019 - Present 📍 STEM UK, London/Southeast England

- Delivered 35+ hours of engagement for STEM UK, presenting to schools to promote science and technology skills (e.g. coding and chemistry). Developed the ability to tailor scientific messaging to different age groups and backgrounds.

Course Ambassador

📅 09/2019 - 09/2021 📍 Cardiff University, Cardiff, Wales

- Elected to represent 200+ students, acting as the primary liaison between the student body and academic staff to implement course improvements within the Department of Chemistry.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree in Chemistry

📅 09/2016 – 07/2021 📍 Cardiff University, Cardiff, Wales

- Four-year integrated MChem degree with an industrial placement year as an Organic Chemist at Pfizer 2019-2020.
- **Classification:** 1st class honours.
- **Project management:** managed four research projects focused on improving chemical sustainability and safety (electrochemistry, earth-abundant metal catalysis, in-flow hydrogenation), then presented the results to 200+ people at Cardiff City Hall.
- **Collaboration and attention to detail:** Published my master's thesis on sustainable organic synthesis using electrochemistry titled "electrochemical azidocyanation of alkenes via 1,4-nitrile migration" in Chem. Commun. 2022, 58, 8658-8661, analysing and explaining complex research data to a broad audience.
- **Collaboration and attention to detail:** Published my master's thesis on sustainable organic synthesis using electrochemistry titled "electrochemical azidocyanation of alkenes via 1,4-nitrile migration" in Chem. Commun. 2022, 58, 8658-8661, analysing and explaining complex research data to a broad audience.
- **Relevant modules:** mathematical modelling, analytical chemistry, organic chemistry, organometallic chemistry, statistical thermodynamics.

A-Levels and GCSEs, Dartford Grammar School / Colfe's Secondary School

📅 09/2013 – 07/2016 📍 Dartford/London, United Kingdom

- A-Levels: Chemistry (A), Biology (B), Design & Technology (B).
- GCSEs: 10 x A* - B grades, including Additional Science (A*) and Core Science (A).

CERTIFICATES

- Google Project Management Professional Certificate
- Automating Real-World Tasks with Python (Google)
- Data Visualisation with Python - Data Analysis with Python (IBM)
- Databases and SQL for Data Science with Python (IBM)
- Machine Learning with Python - Statistics for Data Science with Python (IBM)
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